

Session 5: Expert Judgment and Capstone

Failure patterns, multi-agent teams, and an end-to-end research artifact

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Building a Team of Specialized Agents

Named subagents you define once and invoke on demand. Each has its own scope, system prompt, and tool allowlist — like a team of focused collaborators.

Define one: a markdown file at `~/.claude/agents/<name>.md` (user-level) or `.claude/agents/<name>.md` (project-level).

```
---
name: lit-search
description: Use for multi-database literature searches on a topic.
tools: [mcp__zotero__*, WebSearch, WebFetch]
model: sonnet
---

You are a literature search specialist. Return a structured
bibliography with the key claim from each paper.
```

Activate it:

- Claude reads every agent's description at startup and spawns one when a task matches
- Or invoke it explicitly: *"use the lit-search agent to..."*
- Spawn several in a single message — they run in parallel

Permissions work as usual: any tools the agent uses need to be allowed in `.claude/settings.json`.